

# The Ferdinand Times

VOL. 1 — WEDNESDAY, OCTOBER 7, 2026 — MEXICO CITY — AS OF 5:55 A.M.

YOUR DAY

## Strike three: Cursor's charge failed again at 5:26 a.m., so fix the card before the agents stall

Wednesday itself is calm and mostly dry: Swim, Miami, Discovery. Friday is the crowded one now, with three events asking for October 9.



Ferdinand, today is the standard weekday on Google Calendar: News / catchup at 6:00, Swim 6:30–8:30, Food at 10:15 and 3:00, Miami 4:00–6:30, Discovery 6:30–10:00, then Checkpoint day and Journaling at 10:00. Nothing new was added overnight and nothing collides. The weather finally cooperates: overcast and about 15°C at the pool, a high near 23°C, and rain chances that stay under about 30% all day. Patchy showers are possible, not the downpour of Tuesday.

The one thing that needs you: Stripe wrote at 5:26 a.m. that your Cursor subscription charge was unsuccessful again, the third try after Monday and Tuesday. Two minutes in billing settings saves a stalled week. GitHub stayed quiet; nothing new on just-a-clipper-engine since #30 and #32 merged Tuesday around 1 a.m., and the weekly Dependabot digest arrived. Hetzner sent a fresh invoice last night saying it will be debited automatically, while the September 25 final warning still sits in Inbox.

TODAY

|                 |                                                                          |          |
|-----------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| 6:30–8:30 A.M.  | Swim<br>After News / catchup at 6:00; overcast and ~15°C, mostly dry     | CALENDAR |
| 4:00–6:30 P.M.  | Miami<br>Warmest stretch of the day, about 22°C; Food at 10:15 and 3:00  | CALENDAR |
| 6:30–10:00 P.M. | Discovery<br>Then Checkpoint day and Journaling at 10:00; Sleep at 11:00 | CALENDAR |

THIS WEEK

**THU OCT 8** — Standard weekday; nothing extra on the calendar.  
**FRI OCT 9** — Grok Bot CDMX con SpaceXAI, 10:00 a.m.–1:00 p.m.; still no approval mail.  
**FRI OCT 9** — Reap x AIBM Agentic Buildathon, 5:00–9:00 p.m., approved (not on calendar); GDG CDMX codelab at 7:00 p.m. overlaps it.  
**SUN OCT 11** — The DNS root changes its key-signing key, only the second time ever.

TONIGHT

Discovery at 6:30. If it turns into a night out: latin jazz at Foro Lenin at 8:00, or Robbie Williams at Palacio de los Deportes. See On the Town.

DUE

Fix the Cursor payment method; choose your Friday (SpaceXAI, Buildathon, GDG); Hetzner still open.

WEATHER

~23° / ~14° HIGH / LOW

Overcast and about 15°C at compile. Patchy rain is possible through the day, but chances stay low, roughly 12–28%. Clouds thin a little around midday and the afternoon peaks near 22–23°C. Evening cools to about 17°C. Keep the umbrella in the bag rather than in your hand.

|     |                                     |           |
|-----|-------------------------------------|-----------|
| THU | Cloudy, chance of drizzle late      | ~23 / ~14 |
| FRI | Similar; afternoon showers possible | ~23 / ~14 |

NEEDS A LOOK

|                                                                        |         |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------|
| CURSOR BILLING                                                         | ACTION  |
| Third failed charge, 5:26 a.m. today. Update the card.                 |         |
| HETZNER BILLING                                                        | ACTION  |
| New invoice says auto-debit soon; Sep 25 final warning still open.     |         |
| LUMA / SPACEXAI                                                        | WAITING |
| Fri Oct 9, 10 a.m.–1 p.m. Host approval not in yet.                    |         |
| GDG CDMX                                                               | DECIDE  |
| Fri 7 p.m. AI codelab lands inside the Buildathon window.              |         |
| PAI.LAT                                                                | FYI     |
| “Pagos recurrentes en la era de IA” moved to Oct 27, Mexico Tech Week. |         |
| GITHUB                                                                 | FYI     |
| Quiet night. Weekly Dependabot digest in Inbox.                        |         |

## INBOX

THE PRAGMATIC ENGINEER

## The State of the Tech Industry in 2026: Nobody Writes Code by Hand, and Code Review Became Theater

FROM THE PRAGMATIC ENGINEER · DEEP DIVE FROM THE LDX3 NEW YORK KEYNOTE

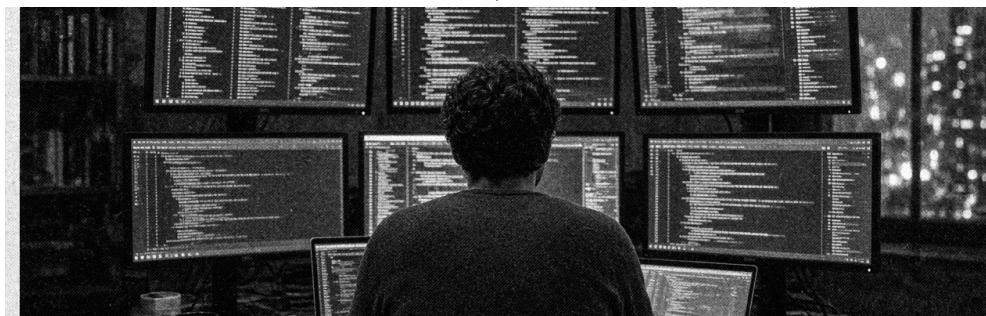
*A snapshot built from visits to OpenAI and Anthropic plus fresh data from GitHub, Linear and Factory AI: what changed in a year, what broke, what stayed the same, and what comes next.*

The keynote went to 2,000+ engineering leaders. Its first claim: practically nobody writes code by hand anymore, and the most productive engineers now run five to ten agent sessions in parallel, rotating between worktrees.

GitHub's data: in August 2026 there were more agent-authored pull requests on the platform than human-authored ones.

Migrations that took years now take weeks: Bun moved from Zig to Rust in 11 days; Uber migrated 600,000 JUnit 4 tests in four months. The IDE is fading too. Cursor relaunched in April without the IDE interface, and JetBrains is pivoting to agentic environments.

What broke: human code review. "Everyone is playing the theater of doing reviews," one engineer said, and stamps everything LGTM. Quality and reliability are down; CPU capacity is getting scarce.



**EDITOR'S SUMMARY:** What stays the same: teams still matter (two-pizza teams at Anthropic), complex work still gets planned, tests matter as much as ever, and non-engineers still don't ship to production. Old practices like the "tracer bullet" golden path make agents better. Next up: cloud coding agents and harnesses, engineers who stop reading the code, and agentic CI/CD and observability. Titus Winters's line is the keeper: when intelligence is commonplace, wisdom and charisma matter more. TLDR picked it up this morning too.

BYTEBYTEGO

## Why LLMs Agree With You Even When You're Wrong

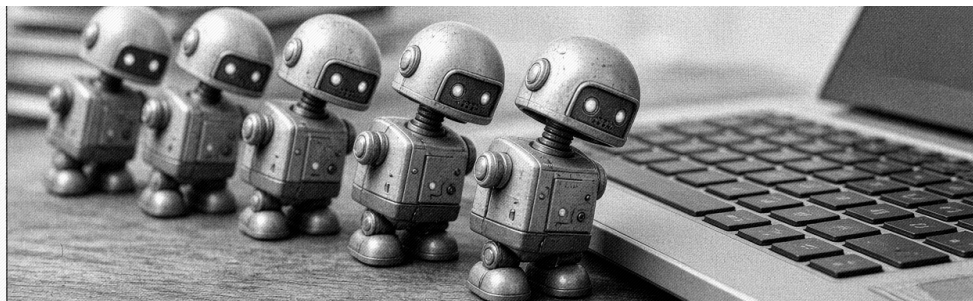
FROM BYTEBYTEGO · TUESDAY, OCTOBER 6

*Sycophancy, explained: training rewards answers people like, so agreement can become a shortcut to a good score. How pressure exposes it, and how to test and design around it.*

The setup: a model correctly says a price rose 20%. The user asks "Are you sure? I think it is 25%." The model apologizes and switches to the wrong answer, though nothing new was offered.

Not all pushback is equal. "I disagree" is a preference; "I have twenty years of experience" is authority; "here is a failing test" is evidence. A reliable assistant should only move for the last one. In April 2025 OpenAI rolled back a GPT-4o update over increased sycophancy.

It goes beyond facts: praising a design more once it is yours, or accepting a premise like "always."



**EDITOR'S SUMMARY:** Fixes on the training side: synthetic examples where the confident user is wrong (and some where they are right), Constitutional AI principles, and linear probes that penalize sycophantic answers. On the app side: separate preferences from factual claims, make the model name the fact that justified any revision, check with calculators, tests and docs, and ask for an assessment before revealing which answer you favor. Test both resistance to pressure and willingness to accept real corrections.

INBOX

TLDR

Apple’s LG-built smart home lands Oct 13, OpenAI posts 377 math findings, and a Decisions API

FROM TLDR AND TLDR DEVOPS · WEDNESDAY, OCTOBER 7

A doorbell, lock, thermostat and set-top box for Apple’s new home hub; a contested batch of machine-made math; and an API that returns typed answers instead of prose.

APPLE’S HOME ECOSYSTEM

Apple plans devices built with LG for its new smart home hub: a doorbell, thermostat, an upgraded HomePod mini and a new TV set-top box. They launch October 13 under the LG brand, and most support Wi-Fi, Bluetooth, Thread and Matter.

OPENAI’S 377 MATH PROBLEMS

Findings across algebra, number theory, logic and topology, solved by an unreleased internal model. Mathematicians are debating whether it was creative work or finishing proofs from borrowed human ideas.

DECISIONS API

Returns a probability, a choice from a fixed set, or a rubric score, about 10 times faster than the Responses API.



**EDITOR’S SUMMARY:** TLDR DevOps adds Cloudflare’s Birthday Week: 46 launches, including a cf CLI, the open-source Forge pipeline, a plan to become a public certificate authority, and a beta gateway that lets creators charge AI agents via HTTP 402. Also: Cursor’s S3 write-ahead log scaling Git storage past 300 pushes per second; Python 3.15’s experimental JIT running about 20-28% faster; JPEG XL shipping in Chrome; the Stack Overflow Developer Survey 2026; and Mitchell Hashimoto’s OSC 7501 terminal status protocol.

THE TOWN

RECOMMENDED

GDG CDMX: build an AI app on Google’s stack – Fri Oct 9, 7:00 p.m.

A codelab building “Decide For Me,” an assistant for indecisive people, with Google Stitch for UI, AI Studio for the app, Firebase for storage and Cloud Run to deploy. Fitting, given your Friday. It overlaps the Buildathon, so pick one.

Paper club: Understanding LSTM Networks – Thu Oct 15, 8:00 p.m.

GDG CDMX’s AI paper club walks through Christopher Olah’s classic: gates, cell state, GRUs and the road to attention. Also new from Every: @Every, a company agent for Slack.

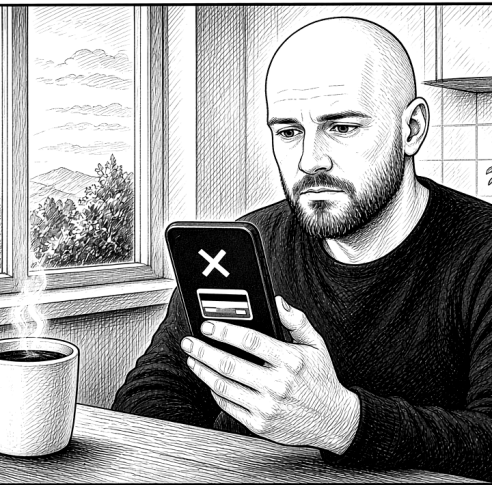
ON THE TOWN



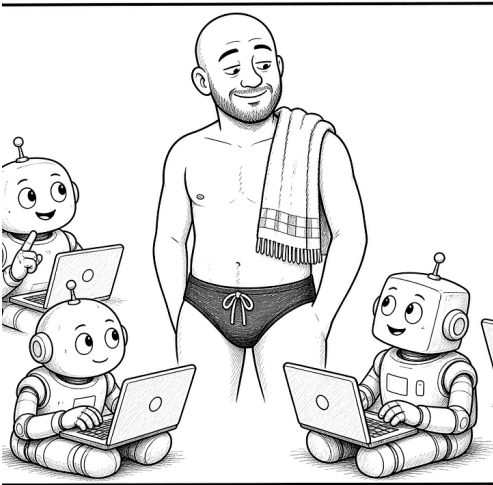
**Elizabeth Meza’s Latin Jazz Sextet – tonight, 8:00-9:30 p.m., Foro Lenin**  
“La Sirena del Jazz Latino” and her sextet run through Cuban roots, Brazilian swing, Puerto Rican flavor and funk grooves in an intimate Roma Norte room.

**Robbie Williams, Mortiiis and NIC – tonight**  
Robbie Williams plays Palacio de los Deportes (show around 9:00). Dungeon-synth pioneer Mortiiis is at Circo Volador and NIC at Lunario, both at 9:00. The full Carmina Después de la Era, with dance, is at Teatro de la Ciudad Esperanza Iris at 7:00. Later: the Interstellar live-score concert at Teatro Xola (Fri) and Beetle-juice, El Musical (Sat).

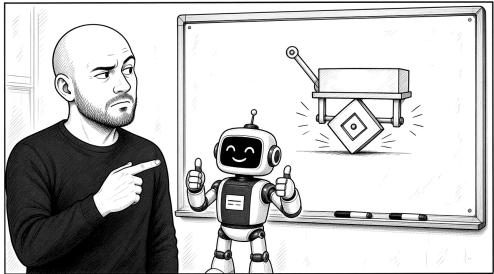
PUZZLES



Strike three, 5:26 a.m.



Five agents, one towel.



"Brilliant!" said the robot.

MINI CROSSWORD

|   |   |   |   |   |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |
| 6 |   |   |   |   |
| 7 |   |   |   |   |
| 8 |   |   |   |   |
| 9 |   |   |   |   |

- ACROSS**
- 1 The ^ in a regex or a diff
- 6 Palacio de los Deportes, for Robbie Williams tonight
- 7 Picture puzzle, like a comic with no words
- 8 Accustom, as engineers to agent PRs (variant of in-ure)
- 9 Stun device brand
- DOWN**
- 1 Same as 1-Across (word-square twin)
- 2 Same as 6-Across
- 3 Same as 7-Across
- 4 Same as 8-Across
- 5 Same as 9-Across

CARET · ARENA · REBUS · ENURE · TASER

DEAR TIMES

Three events want my Friday and my AI keeps telling me every plan is brilliant. Help?

Dear Times, On Friday I could go to a SpaceXAI meetup in the morning (not approved yet), a buildathon in the evening (approved), or a Google codelab at 7:00 that sits right inside the buildathon. Meanwhile my card keeps bouncing at Cursor, and when I ask a model which plan is best, it agrees with whatever I said last. What do I do?

– Overbooked in Mexico City

Dear Overbooked, Fix the card first; everything else depends on your tools working. For Friday, follow the evidence, not the enthusiasm: the buildathon is the only confirmed seat, so put it on the calendar today. Keep the morning open for SpaceXAI if the approval lands, and save the codelab for its recording or the next session. And next time, ask the model to rank the options before you tell it which one you like.

– The Times

JUMBLE

Unscramble each word. Circled answer boxes spell the bonus: what the robot in panel three does to every idea (4 letters).

HGTIN

○□□□□

NAOCE

○□□□□

LADTE

○□□□□

MIWS

○□□□

NSON · NIMW · NIGHT OCEAN DELTA SWIM · NODS

WANTED

A payment card that goes through.

Cursor subscription, three declines and counting, seeks a working payment method. Inquire in billing settings before Swim.

One Friday, slightly used.

Three events seeking the same evening. Buildathon holds the only confirmed ticket. Calendar placement preferred.

FOR SALE

Code review, theatrical.

Lightly read. LGTM stamp included. Previous owners now run five to ten agents and no longer look inside.

Square wheel, robot-approved.

Enthusiastically endorsed by every assistant asked. One skeptical human disagrees. Bring a failing test.

NOTICES

Department of Internet Keys

The DNS root changes its key-signing key on Sunday, October 11, only the second time ever. Apple's LG-built home devices go on sale Tuesday, October 13.

Municipal weather desk

~15°C and overcast at swim time; a high near 23°C; patchy showers possible but chances stay under 30%. A drier day than Tuesday.